Oral defense: sample questions

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AP SEMINAR · BOTH PERFORMANCE TASKS · ASKED BY YOUR TEACHER AFTER YOU PRESENT

These are examples only. College Board says your teacher may ask you different questions. The wording below is College Board's, from the student task directions in the Course and Exam Description. Be ready to answer with specific details about your own work.

Team presentation: one question for each team member

You reflect on your team's collaboration and defend its work. You may be asked about any part of the presentation or research, including what a teammate researched or presented.

1. Student A, how did the group decide to include Student B's perspective/lens/conclusions into the overall presentation?
2. Student A, give one specific way that your thinking changed as a result of learning about Student B's findings.
3. Reflecting on your colleagues' work, which one had the greatest impact on your overall understanding of the problem your group identified?
4. What is an example of a compelling argument from one of your peer's individual reports that you decided to exclude from your team presentation and why?
5. What is a way in which your team's resolution makes you think differently about your own individual research?
6. Describe an argument from one of your peer's individual reports that made you think differently about your team's solution or conclusion?
7. If you had another team member, what other perspectives or limitations could they have researched that would have made a useful contribution to the project?

Individual presentation: two questions, one from each category

Reflection on the research process

1. How did some preliminary information you gathered inform your research?
2. What evidence did you gather that you didn't include? Why did you choose not to include it?
3. How did your research question evolve as you moved through the research process?
4. Did your research go in a different direction than you originally expected?
5. What information did you need that you weren't able to find or locate?
6. How did you approach and synthesize the differing perspectives in order to reach a conclusion?

Extending argumentation through effective questioning and inquiry

1. What additional questions emerged from your research? Why are these questions important?
2. What are the implications of your findings to your community?
3. How is your conclusion in conversation with the body of literature or other research sources you examined?
4. How did you use the conclusions or questions of others to advance your own research?

College Board allows no use of AI to prepare for the oral defense. You may not use it to generate possible answers. Your answers come from your own work.

Oral defense: my evidence

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YOUR OWN NOTES, IN YOUR OWN WORDS

STUDENT CODE _____ PERIOD _____ DATE _____

Do not write answers to memorize. Note where in your own work the evidence is, so that you can speak from it.

Task 1, with my team	Specific details I can point to: reports, dates, decisions
What each teammate found I have read every report	
How we decided what we kept, what we left out, and why	

Task 2, on my own	Specific details I can point to: sources, drafts, pages
My research process what changed, and what I left out	
Beyond my argument new questions, and what my findings mean for others	

Your teacher gives you the list of possible questions, not the exact ones you will be asked. Be prepared to answer every one.